



Netherlands vs England, 2009

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In one of the most thrilling upsets in T20 World Cup history, the Netherlands stunned host England in the opening match of the 2009 edition at Lord's. Asked to bat first, England posted a competitive 162 for five, built around solid contributions from openers Ravi Bopara, who made 46, and Luke Wright, who top-scored with 71. The chase, however, was far from straightforward for the Netherlands. Wickets fell at regular intervals, with James Anderson finishing with figures of three for 23 from his full quota. Despite the pressure, Tom de Grooth (49 off 30 balls) held the innings together and found valuable support from Peter Borren (30) and Ryan ten Doeschate (22 not out). As the equation came down to seven runs from the final over, it was anybody's game. A series of fielding lapses allowed the Dutch to move closer, reducing the requirement to just two off the last ball. Edgar Schiferli pushed the final delivery straight back to the bowler, Stuart Broad, and set off for a single. Broad hurled the ball towards the non-striker's end but missed his target, and the Netherlands capitalised on the mistake, scrambling through for an extra run via overthrows, registering an "unbelievable and special" win, as Dutch captain Jeroen Smits put it.

Australia vs Pakistan, 2010

Semifinal. World Cup. Chasing 192. Against defending champion Pakistan. It didn't get bigger than this. For long stretches of the chase, Australia appeared down and out. At 144 for seven in 17.1 overs, Pakistan was the clear favourite in Gros Islet, Saint Lucia, with runs on the board and pressure firmly on the batting side. Then Michael Hussey decided otherwise. The left-hander kept Australia alive through the 18th over, adding 14 crucial runs alongside No. 9 Mitchell Johnson. Mohammad Amir, who had already claimed three wickets, was brought back for the penultimate over, but Hussey turned the tide — striking two fours and hustling hard between the wickets as 16 came off the over. With 18 needed off the final six balls, Pakistan turned to Saeed Ajmal, the joint second-highest wicket-taker of the tournament. Johnson ensured Hussey was back on strike for the second delivery. Carnage followed. Hussey pulled a short ball for six, slogged the next over long-on for another maximum, then fiercely slashed a four past backward point to level the scores. The contest, and Pakistan's defence, was finally broken with a towering six over long-on as Hussey carried Australia into the final.



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